

Open-source bonanza

Why pay for software, when you can have the same or more, for free?

To get the most out of this Fast Track, you will first need to fully comprehend what the term open-source actually means. 'Open-source' software are those that are freely available to download, edit, use and share, with absolutely no copyright restrictions. There are different types of open-source licenses that provide users with varying degrees of freedom, however, the primary goal of open-source is to encourage experimentation, knowledge-sharing and collaboration.

Microsoft, often, fell on the receiving end of criticism from the Linux community owing to their closed-source nature. However, Windows OS still single-handedly outshines the popularity of all the Linux distros combined. The company was an advocate of proprietary software for a long time, but in the last couple of years, Redmond has increasingly been making contributions to the open-source community. Microsoft is now a member of the Linux Foundation and a regular contributor on Github. In fact, it now owns Github. Other major software companies have also become active members of the open-source community. This equates to more and more open-source applications and software being created to cater to the needs of multiple types of people, organisations and businesses. Since they are open-source in nature, companies